JAMES RICHARD MORRISON

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Experienced Staff Backend Engineer with 14 years building scalable distributed systems and leading technical initiatives across fintech and data infrastructure sectors. Known for designing robust APIs, optimizing database performance under high throughput, and mentoring junior engineers. Pragmatic problem-solver who prefers straightforward solutions over architectural complexity, with hands-on experience shipping features in fast-moving environments.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Staff Backend Engineer

Thought Machine

https://www.thoughtmachine.net

London, United Kingdom

August 2021 - Present

Designed and implemented core ledger microservices handling 50,000+ daily transactions for financial institutions, achieving 99.99% uptime across production environments. Led migration of legacy monolithic payment processing system to Kubernetes-based infrastructure, reducing latency by 65% and enabling horizontal scaling. Mentored team of 5 backend engineers on distributed systems patterns and established code review standards that reduced production incidents by 40%. Built comprehensive monitoring and alerting systems using Prometheus and Grafana, improving incident response time from 20 minutes to 3 minutes average.

Senior Backend Engineer

DataStream Analytics Inc

https://datastreamanalytics.io

Cambridge, United Kingdom

March 2018 - July 2021

Architected event-driven data pipeline processing 2 billion records daily using Kafka and Apache Spark for real-time analytics platform serving 200+ enterprise clients. Developed Python-based ETL framework reducing data processing time by 55% and enabling non-technical users to create custom pipelines through configuration. Implemented GPT-4 API integrations for automated data quality checks and anomaly detection in customer datasets, improving detection accuracy by 78%. Established database optimization practices resulting in 40% reduction in query execution times across 500GB+ datasets using indexing strategies and query profiling.

Backend Engineer

Capital One

https://www.capitalone.co.uk

Nottingham, United Kingdom

June 2010 - February 2018

Built and maintained REST APIs serving card activation and statement retrieval systems for 2 million active customers, handling 10,000 requests per second during peak periods. Developed Java Spring-based microservices for fraud detection pipeline, integrating with machine learning models to flag suspicious transactions with 94% precision. Implemented GitHub Actions for continuous integration and deployment workflows, automating

testing and reducing manual deployment steps by 80%. Optimized SQL queries and database schema design for core customer database, improving transaction completion rates from 96% to 99.8% during high-load periods.

EDUCATION

BSc Computer Science

University of Cambridge

Cambridge, United Kingdom

2006 - 2010

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Java, Python, Go, SQL, Scala

Databases: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, DynamoDB, Elasticsearch, Redis

Frameworks & Tools: Spring Boot, FastAPI, Kafka, Apache Spark, Kubernetes, Docker

Cloud Platforms: AWS (EC2, RDS, S3, Lambda), GCP

Message Queues: RabbitMQ, Apache Kafka, AWS SQS

Monitoring: Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack

Version Control: Git, GitLab, Bitbucket

Other: gRPC, GraphQL, Distributed Systems Design, Database Performance Tuning